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Medicaid cuts force health centers to close

For N.E. clinics teetering on financial edge, loss of revenue leaves patients in the lurch

By Amanda Gokee
GLOBE STAFF

CONCORD, N.H. — For Dr. Melissa Buddensee, Ammonoosuc Community Health Services in Franconia has been home to her medical practice for a decade.

But this summer, she's had to deliver the bad news to her patients that the practice is closing, in part due to Medicaid cuts President Trump signed into law in July.

Around New England, health care providers and experts warned those cuts are a damaging blow to a health system

that was already in trouble. At least two other health facilities in New Hampshire have announced they will close in the fall amid federal Medicaid cuts.

Experts said federally qualified health centers were already on shaky financial ground, as the funding they receive for the care they provide has not kept up with rising costs, such as personnel and medical technology.

Trump's "One Big Beautiful Bill" signed on July 4 includes almost \$1 trillion in cuts to Medicaid, the federal health insurance program for people with low income and disabilities, over

Ammonoosuc Community Health Services will shutter by the end of 2025.

1,400 patients served
\$524,000 of its \$11.5 million operating budget will be lost due to Medicaid cuts.

\$230,000 savings from closing the Franconia location

the next 10 years. The new law is projected to cause 12 million to 16 million people to lose insurance by 2034.

"This kind of was the last straw," Edward D. Shanshala, CEO of Ammonoosuc Community Health Services.

In New Hampshire, about 185,000 residents — about 13 percent of the population — receive health insurance through Medicaid.

In Massachusetts, about 300,000 people are at risk of losing their health coverage over the next decade, and the state stands to lose about \$3.5 billion in funding, state health officials told the Globe in July.

Shanshala said the health center in Franconia, which serves about 1,400
MEDICAID, Page A7

FBI sends 120 agents to help D.C. police

President bypasses mayor, threatens capital takeover

By Perry Stein and Olivia George
WASHINGTON POST

The FBI has begun dispatching about 120 of its agents in overnight shifts to help local law enforcement prevent carjackings and violent crime in Washington, according to two people familiar with the matter, as President Trump threatens a federal takeover of the nation's capital.

Trump, who plans a news conference at the White House on Monday on this topic, compared the forthcoming action against D.C. crime to his administration's aggressive crackdown against illegal immigration at the southern border, saying on Sunday that he plans to "immediately clear out the city's homeless population and take swift action against crime."

"Be prepared! There will be no "MR. NICE GUY." We want our Capital BACK," Trump wrote in a post on his Truth Social social media platform.

The deployment of FBI agents to deal with local crime puts agents from the bureau's counterintelligence, public corruption, and other divisions with minimal training in traffic stops out on the streets in potentially dangerous encounters, diverting them from their typical jobs at the bureau. And it comes as Trump is publicly portraying the city as rampant with violent crime — even as the mayor refutes that characterization, pointing to police data showing a drop in violent crime.

Last week, Trump ordered federal law enforcement agents from several agencies to be deployed on city streets and called for more juveniles to be
D.C. POLICE, Page A6

ONE ROOM, ZERO STUDENTS

At Cuttyhunk fixture, school's out for every season but summer



PHOTOS BY BEN PENNINGTON FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Children walked past the Cuttyhunk Elementary School building earlier this month.

By Marcela Rodrigues
GLOBE STAFF

GOSNOLD — Sitting on top of a hill on the island of Cuttyhunk, the 152-year-old schoolhouse remains empty most of the year.

Cuttyhunk Elementary has old-fashioned chalkboards, creaky wood floors, and a colorful world map on the wall. Built in 1873, it is the only operating one-room schoolhouse in Massachusetts.

And it's also the lone campus of a district that has no students.

The Gosnold School District is meant to serve children in pre-K to eighth grade living on the Elizabeth Islands, southwest of Cape Cod, but its last graduate left in 2019.

Cuttyhunk, an island with lively sum-



Sisters Samantha (left) and Lily Steinsieck hugged while working on arts and crafts at the school.

mers but quiet winters with about 20 year-round residents, is an aging community with no children.

Its schoolhouse is vacant most of the year. But it can't be shuttered.

The school district must remain open in case children move to Cuttyhunk or any other neighboring island, said Margaret Frieswyk, the district's superintendent and sole employee.

"We have to maintain a schoolhouse because if someone moves in tomorrow, we have to educate them," she said.

Frieswyk, an educator with more than 40 years of experience, has been at the helm of the district since 2015. Only a handful of children have attended all at once since she became superintendent.

GOSNOLD, Page A10

Federal grant has key caveat: aid ICE actions

Provision creates dilemma for some local communities

By Danny McDonald
GLOBE STAFF

Every year, a consortium of Boston-area communities applies for millions in federal money to help them boost public safety — through efforts such as intelligence-gathering and cybersecurity.

But this year, there's a catch: The Trump administration's application mandates they use a chunk of the grant money to work with Immigration and Customs Enforcement to remove people who pose a threat.

That provision is already being met with pushback locally, and it could complicate more than \$13 million in prospective grant money for Greater Boston communities, many of which already have rules that explicitly limit how their police departments can work with federal immigration authorities.

"Do we have concerns that that is the poison pill for blue states for them to deny the application?" Brookline Fire Chief John Sullivan asked fellow pub-
BRIC, Page A7

A troubling picture at St. Vincent Hospital

A whistle-blower lawsuit is latest in series of woes tied to staff shortages

By Stella Tannenbaum
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Carla LeBlanc, a nurse and union leader at St. Vincent Hospital, didn't hold back when she appeared on a local podcast in February to discuss the imminent departure of the chief executive of the Worcester hospital. Short-staffing at St. Vincent had contributed to the deaths of patients, she asserted, and the hospital's management and for-profit owner were to blame.

"At this point, I'm not confident that things will be changing for the better," she told the hosts of the podcast called "Outdoor Cats." "You know, I've learned over the last few years that I can never be confident that this company is going to do the right thing."

The hospital, owned by Tenet Healthcare, fired LeBlanc three months later, citing her comments on the podcast as "disloyal, reckless, and maliciously untrue."

Yet, at the time of the podcast, what LeBlanc didn't know was that an investigation by federal and state health care agencies had essentially confirmed that staff shortages were seriously affecting the quality of care.



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Former St. Vincent Hospital nurse Carla LeBlanc sounded the alarm in February over severe staff shortages.


The heat is on and on

Monday: Hot.
High 89-94, low 70-75.

Tuesday: Hotter.
High 91-96, low 70-75.

Sunrise: 5:47. Sunset: 7:51.

Weather and comics, **D4-5.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

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Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky has the most on the line in a summit to which he has not been invited. **A5.**

Business groups back proposed ballot initiatives that would reduce the state income tax and return excess revenues to Massachusetts taxpayers more frequently. **D1.**

The cancellation of US funds for solar conversion for low-income residents frustrates advocates for clean energy and the residents. **B1.**

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu rejected criticism at home and abroad over his plan to take over more parts of the Gaza Strip. **A3.**

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ST. VINCENT, Page A10